

The Gujarat based Kalorex Group are reimagining education to nurture youngsters who are dexterous enough to adapt and succeed in any situation. It is focussed on moulding youngsters who are eager and confident to occupy their place in the global order. Dr. Shroff is creating a nimble organization that is constantly tweaking itself to offer contemporary education, that will empower it ls students to rise up to the challenges of the future.

DR. MANJULA POOJA SHROFF

REWRITING THE DNA OF EDUCATION

The Kalorex Group consists of the Delhi Public Schools, Calorx Olive International School at Ahmedabad and Calorx Public Schools across Western India. As the MD & CEO, Dr. Pooja Manjula Shroff has built a colossal network of 40+ institutions of educational excellence that extend from Pre-Schools to K-12 schools, e-Learning, Edutainment and Special Focus Institutions. Today, Kalorex is recognized as a quality-conscious group with a focus on Innovation and the use of Technology in Learning. She even offers consultancy to other educational institutions that would like to upgrade themselves to the high standards set by Kalorex.

Dr. Shroff is more than just an educationalist. She is a catalyst who is transforming generations of young Indians. Enthusing them to identify their true potential and live up to it, she is instilling ambitious aspirations in youngsters and encouraging them to dare and win. She believes in being the person who opens the doors of the universe and empowers them to go and make the most of the opportunities that it has for them.

With her experience and grasp on student psychology, Dr. Shroff is consciously building an ecosystem that crafts the overall personality of the students, striving to hone their overall development in all areas. The Kalorex impact starts at the Pre-School stage itself. Their research based curriculum, in partnership with the parents, develops the skills of children, laying a strong foundation for their holistic development. Their Early Childhood Foundation Stage - ECFS, is a blend of the British Curriculum with a healthy dose of Finnish Education Methodology. The curriculum is customized to suit Indian Students. As Dr. Shroff says, "We have successfully infused innovations in the curriculum to bring in 21 Century skills, offering a balanced blend of Global & Local learning, making our system truly 'Glocal'.

Dr. Shroff takes great pride in the fact that their system unfetters young children and prods them to open their minds to the world. She lucidly explains child psychology and how they learn. She says, "Children are naturally inquisitive and ask a lot of questions. As they seek answers, it leads to them getting engaged with the topic at hand. This in turn leads them to explore and seek more information. The need to explore leads them to experiment and try their hands in the activity. This exploration and simultaneous experimentation leads to experience. Experience remains etched in their minds. This is the best form of teaching and learning".

A humanitarian at heart, Dr. Shroff firmly believes that education is the biggest tool to empower oneself. Under her guidance, Kalorex started a Parentage Home called Visamo Kids Foundation in 2001. The foundation selects the brightest children from underprivileged backgrounds and supports them with the best shelter, food and nutrition and education until they graduate high school. Kalorex even provides them with financial assistance to pursue higher Education and to stand up for themselves in life.

Prerna is another project that is a testimony to Dr. Shroff's efforts to make education a tool to create an inclusive society. This special school for dyslexics brings in cutting edge teaching practices to an understanding, nurturing environment, enabling and empowering the challenged students to claim their rightful place in society.

Dr. Shroff's untiring efforts to create a new, amalgamated, egalitarian world for the next generation has been applauded and acknowledged by the highest of the land. Chronicling the achievements of Dr. Shroff in her book **Success, Mantras** and **Musings**, Anurita Rathore Jadeja, a senior journalist and media professional, speaks of Dr. Shroff's innate belief in oneself, her art of staying focused, and trusting one's instincts with which she has shaped her own destiny.

Her role as an agent of positive change has been appreciated at several prestigious forums with awards. She is the recipient of the prestigious Secular India Award from the President of India, Shri Shankar Dayal Sharma & Woman of the year by American Bibliography Society, North Carolina.

Dr. Shroff is laying the foundations of a new India. She is a nation builder with a vision that transcends the immediate.